

Monica Vasco

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🌐 <https://sites.google.com/view/monicavasco>

🔍 **Research interests:** Experimental economics, behavioral economics, social networks, economics of education, lab-in-the-field experiments



Education

- Sep. 2024 – now 📖 **Postdoc**, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA.
- Dec. 2021 – Jul. 2024 📖 **Ph.D Data Science**, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Title: *Decision-making and networks among adolescents*
Pre-doctoral stay (2023) at Essex University, UK
- Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2022 📖 **MSc. Economics: Empirical Applications and Policies**, Basque Country University, Bilbao, Spain. Title: *School bullying and social networks*.
- Oct. 2020 – Jul. 2021 📖 **MRes Social Sciences Methods** Loyola Andalucía University, Sevilla, Spain.
Title: *Cognitive abilities, risk-taking and inconsistent choices among teenagers*.
- Sep. 2015 – Jun. 2020 📖 **B.A. Business Administration** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Erasmus (2018) at Derby University, UK
- 📖 **B.A. Law** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.

Employment History

- Dic. 2021 – Jul. 2024 📖 **Research Assistant (FPU)**
Loyola Behavioural Lab, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
- Jan. 2020 – Jun. 2021 📖 **Internship**
Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain

Teaching

- 23/24 📖 **Econometrics** (Instructor of Record, taught in English). Business Administration Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- 📖 **Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- 22/23 📖 **Growth and Development Economics** (Instructor of Record, taught in Spanish). International Relations Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- 📖 **Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.

Research Publications

Published papers

- 1 Vasco, M., Alfonso, A., Arenas, A., Cabrales, A., Cuesta, J. A., Espín, A. M., ... Brañas-Garza, P. (2025). Economic preferences and cognitive abilities among teenagers in Spain. *Scientific Data*, 12, 7.
🔗 doi:10.1038/s41597-024-04298-6
- 2 Vasco, M., & Vázquez-De Francisco, M. J. (2025). Holt-laury as a gumball machine. *PLoS ONE*, 20(4), e0320576. 🔗 doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0320576

- 3 Alfonso, A., Brañas-Garza, P., Jorrat, D., Lomas, P., Prissé, B., Vasco, M., & Vázquez-De Francisco, M. J. (2023). The adventure of running experiments with teenagers. *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, 102048. [doi:10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048)

Working papers

- 1 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Derex, M., & Vasco, M. (2025). Learning and information transfer: Evidence from an intuitive physics task.
- 2 Brañas-Garza, P., Cabrales, A., Kovářík, J., & Vasco, M. (2024). The social footprint of bullying: Evidence from signed peer nominations and tie strength.

Work in progress

- 1 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Rajaomason, M., & Vasco, M. (2026). *Leadership legitimacy, inequality, and protests: A network experiment with university students in madagascar.*
- 2 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2026). *Development of protective behavior and contagion reasoning in a dynamic network SIS game.*
- 3 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025). *The microfoundations of herding behavior: Learning, signals, and connectivity in children's networks.*
- 4 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2025a). *Friendship, enmity, and in-between: Dimensions of social relationships across development.*
- 5 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2025b). *Measuring theory of mind in children and adolescents.*
- 6 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2025c). *Networked decision-making and social learning in children and adolescents.*
- 7 Kovářík, J., Hsieh, C.-S., & Vasco, M. (2025). *Gender differences in friendship networks (across the globe).*
- 8 Brañas-Garza, P., Kovářík, J., Mengel, F., & Vasco, M. (2024). *Seeing less than there is: Misperceptions of social network structure.*

Presentations and research seminars

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| Jul. 2026 | ■ | Borchard Colloquium, Château de la Bretesche, Missillac, France |
| Jun. 2026 | ■ | WEAI 101st Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado, USA |
| Apr. 2026 | ■ | 11th annual conference on Network Science in Economics, Miami, Florida, USA |
| Oct. 2025 | ■ | Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Los Angeles, California, USA |
| | ■ | Economics Science Association (ESA), Tucson, Arizona, USA |
| Jan. 2025 | ■ | Experimental Economics Conference, Bogotá, Colombia |
| Oct. 2024 | ■ | Economics Science Association (ESA), Columbus, Ohio, USA |
| Sep. 2024 | ■ | Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Pasadena, California, USA |
| Feb. 2024 | ■ | Southern Europe Experimental Team's Meeting (SEET), Málaga, Spain |
| Sep. 2023 | ■ | Economics Science Association (ESA), Exeter University, Exeter, UK |
| Jun. 2023 | ■ | IAREP-SABE 47th International Conference, Université Côte d'Azur, Nice, France |
| Jan. 2023 | ■ | Graduate Student Workshop in Experimental Economics, Chapman University, USA |
| Jun. 2022 | ■ | Conference on Human Capital Investments, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain |
| Jun. 2021 | ■ | e3c LATAM PhD Workshop, Universitat Illes Balears, Balearic Islands, Spain |

Funding

- Dec. 2021 – Nov. 2025  **FPU**, PhD grant (FPU20/o5846)
Spanish Ministry of Universities
- Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2025  **Decisions, Education, Networks and Teenagers**, (PID2021-126892NB-I00)
Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation
IPs: Pablo Brañas and Antonio Cabrales

Skills

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| Languages |  English (fluent), Spanish (native) |
| Software |  R (RStudio), Stata, oTree, Qualtrics, Matlab, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Knime, Weka |
| Quantitative Methods |  Econometrics, Experimental Design, Social Network Analysis, Causal Inference, Survey Design, Lab-in-the-Field Experiments |
| Research & Project Management |  Coordination of field experiments, data collection management, IRB compliance, participant recruitment and incentives, collaboration with schools and research teams |

References

Pablo Brañas (advisor)
Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad Loyola Andalucía
 branasgarza@gmail.com

Jaromír Kovářík (co-advisor)
Associate Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad del País Vasco
 jaromir.kovarik@ehu.es

Antonio Cabrales
Professor of Economics (Research Chair)
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
 antonio.cabrales@uc3m.es

Isabelle Brocas
Professor of Economics
University of Southern California
 brocas@usc.edu